



Market Intelligence Report - McDonald's (Group 3)

Ololade Oroyemi, Alison Sellers, Avery Sellers, Yijun Sun,
Harrison Whitmore, Zitong Zhao, and Winnie Zheng
Scheller College of Business, Georgia Institute of Technology

MGT 3300: Marketing Management I

Dr. Tracey Swartz

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Company Overview

Company Background

McDonald's was founded in 1940 in California as a small scale drive-in restaurant.¹ The restaurant was launched by brothers Richard and Maurice McDonald.¹ Their focus was simple: serving up burgers, fries, and drinks with quick service.² In 1948, they introduced the "Speedee Service System," using assembly-line methods to make their kitchen more efficient, a move that changed the fast-food industry forever.³ Ray Kroc, a traveling salesman, saw huge potential in what the McDonald brothers were doing and helped them open their first franchise in Illinois. Eventually, Kroc bought out the brothers and led McDonald's on an aggressive path to global expansion.⁴

McDonald's rapid growth is correlated to famous menu items like the Big Mac and the Happy Meal.⁸ Currently, McDonald's is located in more than 100 countries, and serves about 69 million customers daily.⁷ The secret to their success lies in their franchise model, focus on quality, and commitment to speed and convenience.⁵

Mission Statement

McDonald's mission statement highlights its commitment to delivering enjoyable dining experiences and fostering a sense of community. According to the company, its mission is "to make delicious feel-good moments easy for everyone"⁵ (par. 1). This mission underscores McDonald's focus on creating a positive customer experience, offering food that is accessible and enjoyable, while maintaining a commitment to operational efficiency.⁵

Company Demographics

McDonald's is a fast-food restaurant chain. The corporation reported a total revenue of 11.384 billion dollars by the end of June 2022 and 12.395 billion dollars by the end of June



2023, increasing total revenue by 9 percent in two six-month periods.⁹ In 2023, McDonald's had approximately 150,000 employees worldwide,¹⁰ 35% of which are Hispanic, and 57% are women.¹¹ As of 2023, there are a total of 40,301 retail store locations in over 120 countries worldwide, with 14,146 (36.92 %) being in the U.S. alone, followed by Japan with 2,975 locations (7.76%), and China with 2,700 locations (7.05%).⁹ The McDonald's Corporation reports operation in three global sectors; the U.S. sector centers in on services in the United States. The international operated markets sector combines operations in Canada, Australia, and multiple countries in Europe, such as Germany and the UK¹². "The international developmental licensed market and corporate segment consists developmental licensee and affiliate markets in the McDonald's system"¹² (par. 1).

Organizational Structure¹³

The McDonald's Corporation is managed by a board of directors, who oversees and establishes goals and strategies for the corporation. The board includes:

- Chris Kempczinski – Chairman of the Board and CEO of the McDonald's Corporation
- Anthony G. Capuano – Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Kareem Daniel – Independent Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Lloyd H. Dean – Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Catherine M. Engelbert – Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Margaret H. Georgiadis – Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Mike Hsu – Independent Director of McDonald's Corporation
- John J. Mulligan – Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Jennifer L. Taubert – Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Paul S. Walsh – Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Amy E. Weaver – Director of McDonald's Corporation
- Miles D. White – Lead Independent Director of McDonald's Corporation



Immediate Environment

Competitors

As the fourth largest fast food chain in the world, Kentucky Fried Chicken (KFC) is McDonald's largest competitor by volume.¹⁴ KFC's greatest strengths are its iconic branding, including its best-in-industry mascot, Colonel Sanders, and signature phrase 'finger licking good', as well as its bone-in chicken, which McDonald's does not offer.¹⁵ That said, KFC is heavily reliant on chicken compared to McDonald's and has faced numerous public relations issues, including scandals over the use of hormones in poultry raising, alleged incidents of improperly cooked or sanitized chicken, and claims that its founder used a slur.¹⁶

Burger King is the largest restaurant chain that focuses on the same products as McDonald's, making it another major competitor.¹⁴ Burger King's strengths include its Impossible Whopper, a vegetarian option that American McDonald's has no answer for, and a more varied menu.¹⁷ However, Burger King struggles during breakfast hours, holding only 1/12th of McDonald's market share in that arena.¹⁸ It has also been accused of false advertising multiple times, resulting in lost consumer trust and several lawsuits.^{19, 20}

Corporate Partners

Since its infancy in the 1950s, McDonald's has maintained a close relationship with the Coca-Cola Company.²¹ McDonald's has been listed as Coca-Cola's fourth largest customer by nation, is the only client for which Coca-Cola has a corporate division solely devoted, and has a reputation among consumers for serving the best Coca-Cola available, largely because its restaurants have a unique process for handling the iconic soft drink.²¹

McDonald's 'McDelivery' service is largely made possible via a partnership with ride-sharing and delivery company Uber.²² Orders placed through the McDonald's mobile app are



fulfilled through UberEats, allowing both companies to expand their operations without stepping outside their competitive niches.²² McDonald's has a very similar, though seemingly less expansive, arrangement with UberEats competitor Doordash.²³

Physical Environment

As the largest fast food chain in the world, McDonald's has a commensurately huge environmental impact. The biggest culprit is the burger chain's dependence on beef. McDonald's sells over 7 million cows worth of beef yearly, and, as such, is responsible for an enormous amount of greenhouse gas production, water usage, and deforestation involved in cattle raising.²⁴ McDonald's also either directly or indirectly occupies a substantial amount of land between its over 40,000 locations across the globe and the massive amounts of farmland required to produce the food it serves.²⁵

That said, McDonald's - likely in an effort to market to climate conscious customers - has made some efforts to reduce its environmental footprint. It sources nearly all of its packaging materials from recyclers, has a program to identify deforestation and water pollution when that happens on its watch, has joined a UN pledge to reach net-zero emissions by 2040, and is reducing the yearly emissions of its restaurants and supply chain operations.²⁶

Macroenvironment

Culture

In different regions, cultural preferences significantly influence the consumer behavior in the fast food industry. In the United States, fast food remains popular especially in the South and Midwest, where hearty food and affordable prices are very important.²⁷ However, in states such as Connecticut and New York, there is an increasing demand for organic food choices, which has led many fast food companies to introduce salads, fruit, and low-calorie options.^{28,29,30} Globally,



fast food companies often localize their menus to reflect regional tastes, such as offering vegetarian options in India, where beef is prohibited, and using seasonal items in Japan to meet cultural preferences.³¹ Additionally, there is a stronger emphasis on quality ingredients and regional cuisine in Europe, so many fast food chains are incorporating local ingredients and traditional dishes into their menus.^{31,32}

Demographics

McDonald's appeals to customer segments of various age, income, education, gender, and ethnicities around the world. However, for this project, demographics will be based on the United States. Since the last twenty years, there has been a gradual decline of birth rates, and the nation's median age is 38.9 years with an increase of 0.2 years from 2021 and 2022.³³ The median household income was \$80,610 in 2023, which is a 4% increase from 2022.³⁴ In 2022, the percentage of high school graduates and college graduates is 91.2% and 37.2%, respectively, and both have significantly increased from 1960.³⁵ According to the U.S Census Bureau in their 2020 Census, the Some Other Race population, which the majority identified as Hispanic or Latino, is the fastest growing racial population with an increase of 129% since 2010.³⁶ Meanwhile, the White population experienced a decrease of 8.6%, but it remains the largest racial population.³⁶ Since 2013, there have been more females than males with 51.1% females and 48.9% males.³⁷ Among those, "7.6% of U.S. adults now align themselves with the LGBTQ+ community - up from 3.5% in 2012"³⁸ (p.2).

Social

Recently, more and more customers are demanding eco-friendly and sustainable products and advocating for "sustainable packaging, fair prices and a fair living income for producers and farmers, and minimizing waste and pollution"³⁹ (p. 3). In response, many companies are adopting



more sustainable practices, such as to reduce energy used and waste generated from operations, in their businesses to increase the value and reputation of their products.⁴⁰ Moreover, as climate change and pollution receives awareness, American consumers, especially Gen-Z, are more committed to purchase from environmentally friendly and socially responsible brands.⁴¹ This results in consumers' preferences in purchasing products with sustainable packaging and brands with ESG-related claims.⁴² In a study conducted by McKinsey & Co., they also noticed that 82% of US consumers are investing in products and services that prioritizes their health and wellness.⁴³ Consumers are paying more attention to nutrition labels, reducing sugar levels, and seeking sustainable diets.⁴⁴ There is a growing emphasis on reducing food waste as consumers are aware of the concerns related to world hunger, climate change, and rising food costs.⁴⁵ With the advancement in Internet of Things (IoT), Artificial Intelligence (AI), and machine learning, companies can use real-time tracking and monitoring, inventory management systems, and predictive analytics to reduce food waste and optimize food distribution.⁴⁶ Finally, both consumers and companies are donating uneaten and unexpired food to local communities with hungry people to reduce food waste and improve food security.⁴⁷

Technology

In the current era of rapid development in information technology, AI, robotics, IoT and some other technologies are shaping different industries, including the fast-food industry. With the integration of these technologies in companies, they are not only limited to help enhance efficiency but also improve predictive analytics and customer service for decision-making and business support. As illustrated in the data from Statista, with major organizations investing in new and emerging technologies to drive business and digital transformation, global overall IT spending is expected to grow by 8% between 2023 and 2024 to approximately \$5 trillion U.S.



dollars.⁴⁸ Collaborative robots (cobots) play a vital role in industries facing labor shortages by working alongside human employees, while IoT further optimizes real-time data collection in areas such as logistics and healthcare.⁴⁹ Additionally, a small portion of businesses within the restaurant industry started to integrate robots and smart machines for cooking, packing, and delivering food. This could improve productivity and consistency in food preparation, and reduce labor costs and labor strength.⁵⁰ However, these advancements come with growing concerns over data privacy and security. Governments and businesses are applying stricter regulations, such as the European Union's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), to deal with these threats and ensure alignment with evolving privacy standards.⁷⁸

Economic

In 2024, the inflation rate (Consumer Price Index) for the national consumers has increased to 3.4%.⁵¹ From the report of the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS), the Consumer Price Index rose 2.5% for the 12 months ending August 2024, which continues to strain consumers and businesses alike.⁵² In addition, the government maintained the federal funds with a high interest rate of 5.33% as of mid-September 2024.⁵³ As the interest rate increases, with the high inflation rate, consumers tend to save up money instead of spending in the market. This leads to lower consumer buying power and reduced affordability for loans and credits. At the same time, the U.S. dollar has maintained a steady exchange rate against the Euro at approximately 1.1085 USD to 1 Euro.⁷⁷ Overall, this dynamic combination of the inflation rate, interest rate, and exchange rate shapes the landscape of the economic landscape and affects consumer behaviors and business decisions.



Political/Legal

The operations of the fast food industry are influenced by different laws and policies around the world. In the United States, policies such as the Affordable Care Act have impacted employee benefits and wages, requiring companies to adjust their labor policies.⁵⁴ Globally, rising minimum wage standards have forced companies to raise employee wages, especially in the United States and Europe.⁵⁵ However, trade tensions between the United States and other countries like China have also affected the whole industry's supply chain, such as sourcing raw materials in the international market.⁵⁶ Additionally, companies must follow food safety and environmental regulations, like restrictions on plastics, which are becoming more common in European and Asian countries.⁵⁷

SWOT

Strengths:	Weaknesses:
Strong Brand Recognition: Recognizable globally with consistent branding.⁷⁰ Extensive Global Presence: Over 38,000 outlets worldwide.⁶³ Operational Efficiency and Supply Chain Management: Optimized supply chain ensuring consistent quality and fast service.⁵⁹ Menu Innovation: Adapts menu to meet changing preferences and local tastes.⁶¹	Dependence on Franchise Model: Limits control over daily operations, leading to inconsistent experience.⁶⁰ Perception of Unhealthy Food: Criticism for promoting fast food linked to health issues.⁵⁸ High Employee Turnover: Increased costs due to high turnover in lower-level positions.⁶⁶ Limited Flexibility in Supply Chain: Challenges in adapting to sudden market changes or disruptions.⁶⁸
Opportunities:	Threats:
Growing Demand for Plant-Based Products: Expansion of menu with plant-based options like the McPlant.⁶² Digital Transformation and Delivery Services: Growth in digital customer base through online ordering and delivery.⁷² Expanding into Emerging Markets: Capitalizing on untapped markets with growing urban populations.⁶⁵ Focus on Sustainability: Commitment to sustainable sourcing and eco-friendly packaging.⁶⁷	Intense Competition: From global and local fast-food chains.⁶⁴ Changing Consumer Preferences: Shift towards healthier eating habits.⁶⁹ Economic Fluctuations: Vulnerability to economic downturns and currency fluctuations.⁷¹ A growing international population: increases demand for diverse fast food options.⁷³



Objectives/Goals

We propose that McDonald's introduce a new product to the United States. With the growing demand for healthy fast food alternatives, we believe that McDonald's should introduce plant-based nuggets, burgers, and breakfast sandwiches to their menu. Bringing these healthy alternatives aligns with McDonald's' objective to serve food that their customers feel good about consuming.⁵ Furthermore, plant-based alternatives provide a means of sustainability, which especially appeals to Gen-Z and millennial consumers.⁷⁴ Currently, McDonald's offers the McPlant burger to other continents such as Australia, and Europe, however, they have not yet introduced permanent plant-based menu items within the US.⁷⁵ In order to effectively achieve this segment market, McDonald's could leverage its current partnership with Beyond Meat to offer this selection to franchises within the US.⁷⁶ In addition, McDonald's should consider trying this item within a select number of stores with a demographic of vegan consumers. Our team suggests that the plant-based menu offerings should begin within an area like Portland, Oregon due to the large population of vegan consumers. The menu offerings should be provided within all Portland franchises for 3 months, and then begin to offer these selections to other cities in the months following. We propose that McDonald's offer plant-based products beginning spring 2025.

Next, we suggest that McDonald's consider a market development strategy for growth and implement an international cuisine swap. This would entail bringing some of the most popular food items on McDonald's menus in other countries to the US and vice versa. For example, the Singapore favorite, Samurai Burger, could be brought to United States franchises. By offering select international cuisine options in the US, McDonald's could attract a new customer segment consisting of foreigners. In order to capture this opportunity in the market



space, McDonald's could rely on its current global supply chain. This method would ultimately open up new opportunities for farmers and manufacturers within other countries to produce food to be sold within the US. Our team suggests that McDonald's begins to integrate popular foreign food to the US in the fall of 2025. This would allow the company time to coordinate with the supply chain management within foreign countries. In order to appeal to consumers of all nationalities, we suggest that McDonald's offers a single international menu item for one month's time and then switch the offering following each month.



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Research Objective

Our team's chief research objective is to assess customer preferences and demand for international cuisine items on McDonald's menu. Specifically, our team would like to address the particular demographic consisting of ethnic minorities living within the U.S. and determine whether this group would demand these goods. Based on the most recent census data, the Some Other Race population has increased 129% within the last 10 years and has been identified as the fastest-growing population¹. In addition, we believe that many Americans may be interested in purchasing international food as the average American household spends 10% of its yearly income on fast food². Ultimately, we would like to determine which customer demographic would lead to an increase in McDonald's sales and brand perception, by evaluating price, geographic, psychographic, and promotional preferences.

Research Design

To achieve our goal of understanding customer interest in adding international menu items at McDonald's, we created a Google Form survey (link: <https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfhLgukxNTm47d4kUNxx-0V2ndAvStgFG3VUnjttQtgU9C1w/viewform>). We chose a survey as a means of collecting data because we wanted to reach a large demographic in multiple geographic regions. We designed questions aimed at both ethnic minorities and majorities in the United States to find out if their interest in international cuisine comes from curiosity or a desire for comfort, particularly for those who might be away from home and looking for familiar tastes. Along with assessing interest, we included questions about pricing, location preferences, and promotions to gain a clearer picture of the factors that influence their choices. In designing these questions we asked both structured and unstructured questions. For questions related to demographics, we used



structured questions. However, for questions related to life-style and behavior, we asked unstructured questions to gain a better understanding of emotion, motivations, and experiences. More specifically, through these unstructured questions, we aimed to explore psychographic, behavioral, and benefit-focused aspects, allowing us to delve into the deeper values and behaviors of our target audience. We distributed our survey by posting the link on various social media platforms and placing QR codes in different cities in the Atlanta Metropolitan Area.

The survey aligns with our goal of identifying key customer segments and determining which demographic groups are most likely to enhance McDonald's sales and brand image. While the design is comprehensive, we are open to making adjustments and improvements to ensure we gather the most valuable insights.

One of the flaws in our research is the lack of diversity in our sample group. For example, approximately 50% of the sample group were between the ages of 18-24 and around 35% have at least some college credit, displaying that the majority of the group are of the younger generation and/or current college students. Similarly, around 65% of the sample group associate in the White racial group, and around 70 % identify as a female. These statistics display that there was not much demographic variety in the sample group, which could make one wonder if the research can accurately predict what approach the company should take for the more diverse market of consumers. This research study could have been improved by finding a more diverse sample group in general.

Another flaw is there were a few comments from the sample group about the survey being too lengthy and asking questions that sound similar to others already asked. This could cause the participants to become impatient and begin to answer questions without much insight,

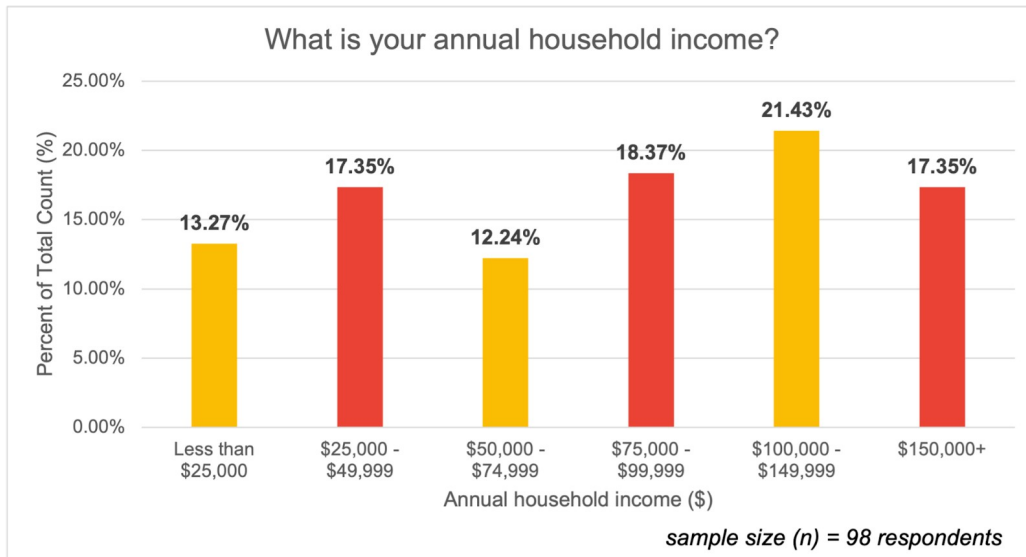


or even select random answers, potentially making the findings less accurate. This could have been improved by testing the survey with a couple more people before releasing it to the sample.

Data Analysis & Insight Development

Our survey had 100 respondents within the week that it was open. The summary statistics of our sample's demographic profile is:

- 70% female, 27% male, and 3% identify as non-binary
- 65% White, 15% Asian, 10% Black or African American, 8% Hispanic or Latino, 2% Mixed or Multiracial
- 48.47% in age group 18-24, 9.09% in 25-34, 10.10% in 35-44, 23.23% in 45-54, 7.07% is older than 55, and 2.02% is under 18 years old
- 13.27% in income brackets is less than \$25,000, 17.35% in \$25,000 - \$49,999, 12.24% in \$50,000 - \$74,999, 18.37% in \$75,000 - \$99,999, 21.43% in \$100,000 - \$149,999, 17.35% in \$150,000+, and 2% with no responses
- 35% have some college credit but no degree, 31% have Bachelor's degree, 15% are high school graduate, 15% have Master's degree, 2% have less than high school diploma, and 2% have a degree in PhD or higher

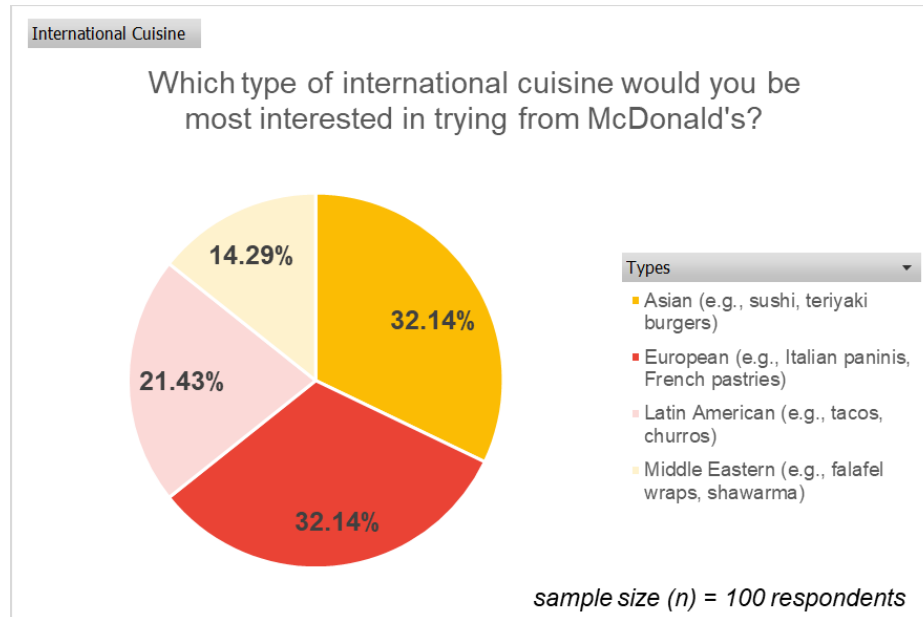


For the annual household income question, there was 2% with no responses. To address this non-response issue in income-related questions, especially sensitive topics like income brackets, we can provide clear answer options, such as “prefer not to say” or “N/A”, which acknowledge respondents’ hesitation and allow them to skip the sensitive question while understanding their intention. Additionally, when designing the survey, we can also make all the questions required to ensure the survey is fully completed before submission, preventing missing responses and ensuring a more complete dataset from respondents.

All of the respondents are located in the south region of the United States. With 47% of respondents coming from urban areas, 35% from rural areas, and 18% from suburban areas. These urban cities are economic and cultural hubs, so respondents from these locations may live in densely populated areas with better technology use, public services, transportation, etc. These opportunities make the concentration comparison from rural to suburban. Among the respondents, 75% live in Georgia. For those living in Georgia, 29.3% reside in the city of Atlanta and 13.3% are from Cartersville. Curious about the taste preferences of the region, we discovered that our sample of southerners prefer Asian or European cuisines, where both choices



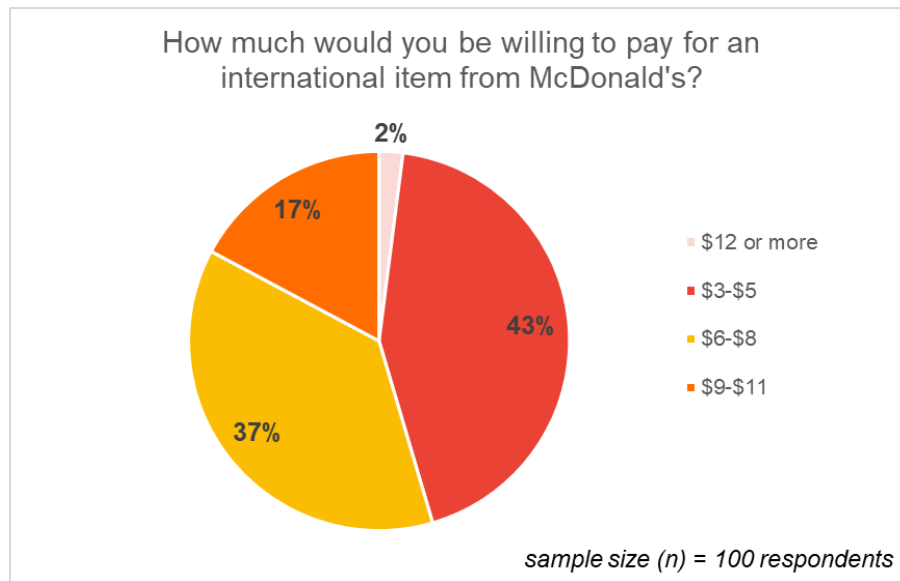
received 32.14% of the vote. The international cuisine must provide our respondents with the benefits of enjoying unique flavors and experiencing new cultures, as 47.9% pursue the former and 16.7% prioritize the latter. Regarding our survey sample, they can be described as people with a growth mindset and authenticity, since 61.90% perceive themselves to be adventurous and open to new things while 33.33% see themselves to prefer both new things and familiar things.



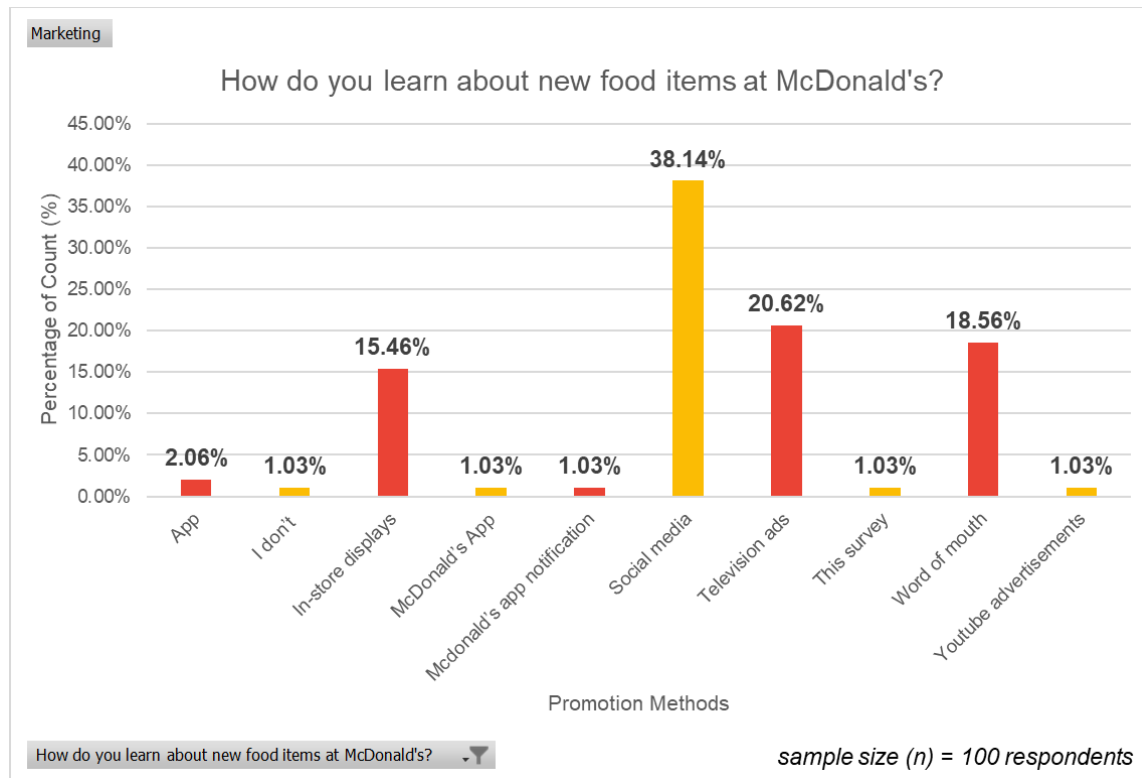
When we asked the respondents how much they are willing to pay for an international item at McDonald's, 43% replied \$3 to \$5 and 37% replied \$6 to \$8. We noticed that price is an important aspect that influences the sample's purchasing behavior, because 52.27% of the respondents answered "not likely" or "unlikely" if the international item is priced 20% higher than a regular menu item. Moreover, location plays a crucial factor as well, where 64% of the respondents are more likely to purchase an international menu item if it were offered at all locations instead of only selected locations. This aligns with the majority of the respondents' preference to travel to a nearby McDonald's since 53.57% would only eat at McDonald's if it is 5-15 minutes away from their house. Overall, our sample consumers would choose to eat at



McDonald's due to their benefits of cheapness and convenience, where 31.1% enjoyed the cheap price and 32.2% enjoyed the convenience and efficiency.



Upon being asked how do they learn about new food items at McDonald's, 38.14% are through social media, 20.62% are from television, and 18.56% are by word of mouth. For the respondents, 36.3% selected promotions involving discounts and price, such as buy one get one free (BOGO), and 22% selected social media with celebrity endorsements to be their highest appeal to try international cuisine at McDonald's. Furthermore, their consumption behavior can be influenced by their spouse and children. Out of those respondents with either a spouse, children, or both, 94.4% reported that their family members influence their decisions of where to eat. Finally, for the respondents that purchase at McDonald's, the majority of them are occasional consumers of McDonald's. When they were asked why they purchased at McDonald's, no one mentioned the McDonald's rewards program that is aimed to benefit its loyal consumers.



Based on the collected data, several business insights can be gleaned. First, since the majority of our respondents are female (70%), between 18-24 years old (48.47%), discover new product releases through social media (38.14%), and are attracted to promotional campaigns with celebrity endorsement (22%), we can enhance the promotion for the launch of our international cuisine item through advertisements on social media by partnering with popular influencers that young women find inspiring and view as role models. Second, 53.57% of respondents prefer McDonald's locations within 5-15 minutes of distance and 64% of respondents are more likely to purchase the international cuisine item if it is offered in all locations. Therefore, it would be ideal to launch our product across all the McDonald's locations in Atlanta, where 75% of the respondents live in Georgia with 29.3% concentrated in Atlanta. Third, based on the acceptance of international items between \$3 to \$8 is 80%, we can keep the pricing of international items within the \$3 to \$8 range, ensuring the price remains affordable and competitive for the target



market. Considering that increase in price is a highly sensitive factor that negatively influences the respondent's purchase decision (52.27%), we can offer price discounts preferred by 36.3% of the respondents through the McDonald's rewards program, such as buy one get one free (BOGO). Not only would this encourage consumers to purchase the international cuisine item, it will also encourage them to become loyal customers by frequently ordering at McDonald's to earn points in the app. Finally, we can include family bonding activities, such as family meal deals that cater to shared dining experiences, in our promotional campaign for the new product. Since 32.14% of respondents favor Asian cuisines, we can incorporate the Asian culture with their emphasis on family to encourage those who want to experience new culture (16.7%) or are adventurous and open to new things (61.90%). This can stimulate more families to try the new product, especially for 94.4% of the respondents with spouses and/or children who reported that their family members influence their decisions of where to eat.

**STP**

	Primary Market (Fast Food)
<u>Geographic</u>	Country: United States Region: Southeast Area within region: Atlanta Metropolitan Area, Georgia
<u>Demographic</u>	
Age	18-24 (Gen Z)
Gender	Female
Income	\$100,000 - \$150,000 (household)
Education Level	Some college credit or Bachelor's Degree
Race	White, Asian
<u>Psychographic</u>	
Lifestyle	Busy Lifestyle; • Eats out frequently for the convenience • Unable to frequently travel abroad for an international experience Married and/or Has Children; Receptive to family activity marketing campaigns Mobile; Willing and able to travel 5 - 30 minutes to reach a McDonald's Technologically Adept; • Sees and pays attention to social media advertising • Uses mobile order/loyalty reward apps for restaurants Frugal; Happy to pay \$3 - \$8 for an international food item
Self-Concept	Adventurous and Open-Minded
Self-Values	Values being connected to other cultures, especially through food Wants to try new things, become more worldly Desires to have a varied palette and taste in foods
<u>Benefit</u>	Enjoying unique flavors Experiencing new cultures Convenience and comfort of a familiar brand Good value for money spent
<u>Behavioral</u>	Non-habitual decision maker Occasional customers; receptive to special and limited-time event style marketing

Target Market Based on Segmentation

Positioning Statement

For young, adventurous people who seek new international experiences, McDonald's offers international food options that combine unique cultural flavors with the comfort, convenience, and value of a well known, close to home fast food chain.

Final Recommendation / Action Plan



Based on our research findings, we recommend that McDonald's introduce the Samurai Pork Burger, an international menu item popular in Thailand³. The launch of this new, unique flavor in the United States is designed to attract young women aged 18-24, especially in the Atlanta area. According to our survey, 80% of respondents are willing to pay between \$3 and \$8 for international cuisine. This allows us to set a strategic price point at \$5.50⁴, which meets with McDonald's existing strategy while remaining affordable. Additionally, promotional strategies like buy one get one free (BOGO) will likely encourage price sensitive consumers to try this product.

For the product launch and marketing strategy, we propose launching the product during Asian Heritage Month in May 2026. This will increase cultural relevance and maximize product awareness. McDonald's typically requires one year for new product development, so we expect to complete research, development, and necessary legal approvals between January 2025 to January 2026⁵. During this phase, we recommend organizing tasting events through beta testing with a few potential customers from our target market to improve the product based on their feedback.

Operational and supply chain adjustments are very important for a smooth rollout. Since McDonald's never released any pork-related products in the United States, we need to secure new partnerships with American meat distributors that specialize in pork. Moreover, McDonald's must adjust their logistics to deliver authentic Samurai Pork Burger seasoning to both the United States and Thailand by early 2026. By March 2026, we plan to increase marketing efforts with targeted social media campaigns on platforms like TikTok and Instagram. Collaborations with popular celebrities and influencers known for their love of Asian cuisine or cultural influence will further broaden the product's appeal. The product launch will be scheduled for all



McDonald's locations in Atlanta in May 2026, catering to 64% of respondents who prioritize convenience. We aim to sell 50,000 units by October 2026, with family-oriented promotions playing a key role, as 94.4% of survey participants indicated family influence on their dining choices. If successful, this product can be expanded to other markets in the eastern and western United States.

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